

Unlocking Journalism Philanthropy for Independent Creators



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Vice President
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Raised \$30M in philanthropic support over six years with her team for CalMatters as COO/CDO

Board Chair, Institute for Nonprofit News; board member New York Times Communities Fund and the Journalism Refugees Education Fund

Veteran reporter, editor, Center for Investigative Reporting/Reveal, Patch, others



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Managed journalism grants and initiatives at Knight Foundation, including programs focused on pro bono legal support for journalists, reducing misinformation and newsroom startup development.

Board Member, Trusting News and Informed California Foundation

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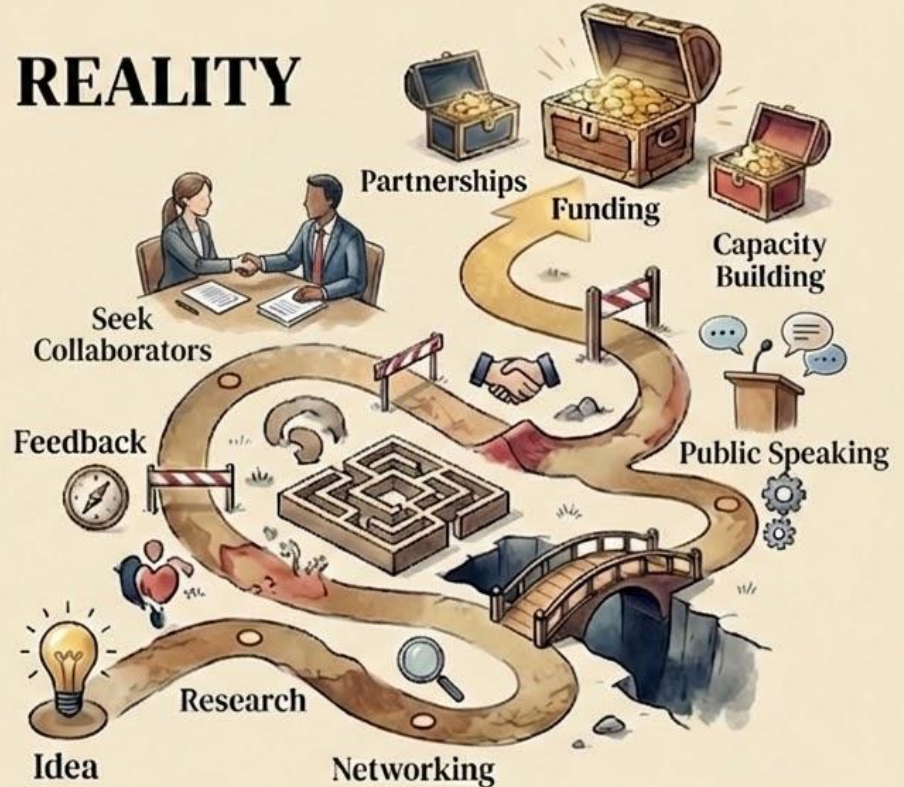
- i Verbal Pitches Vs. Written Pitches**
- ii Writing a One-Pager and Proposal**
- iii Preparing a Budget**
- iv Navigating the Grantmaking Machinery**

The Funding Journey: Expectation Vs Reality

EXPECTATION



REALITY



Verbal Pitches Vs. Written Pitches

Verbal Pitches



- **Key Characteristics:** Direct, engaging, immediate feedback.
- **Best for:** Initial connections, storytelling.

Vs.

Written Pitches



- **Key Characteristics:** Detailed, structured, asynchronous.
- **Best for:** Formal proposals, complex information.

Structuring a Pitch



The Gap
(The Problem)

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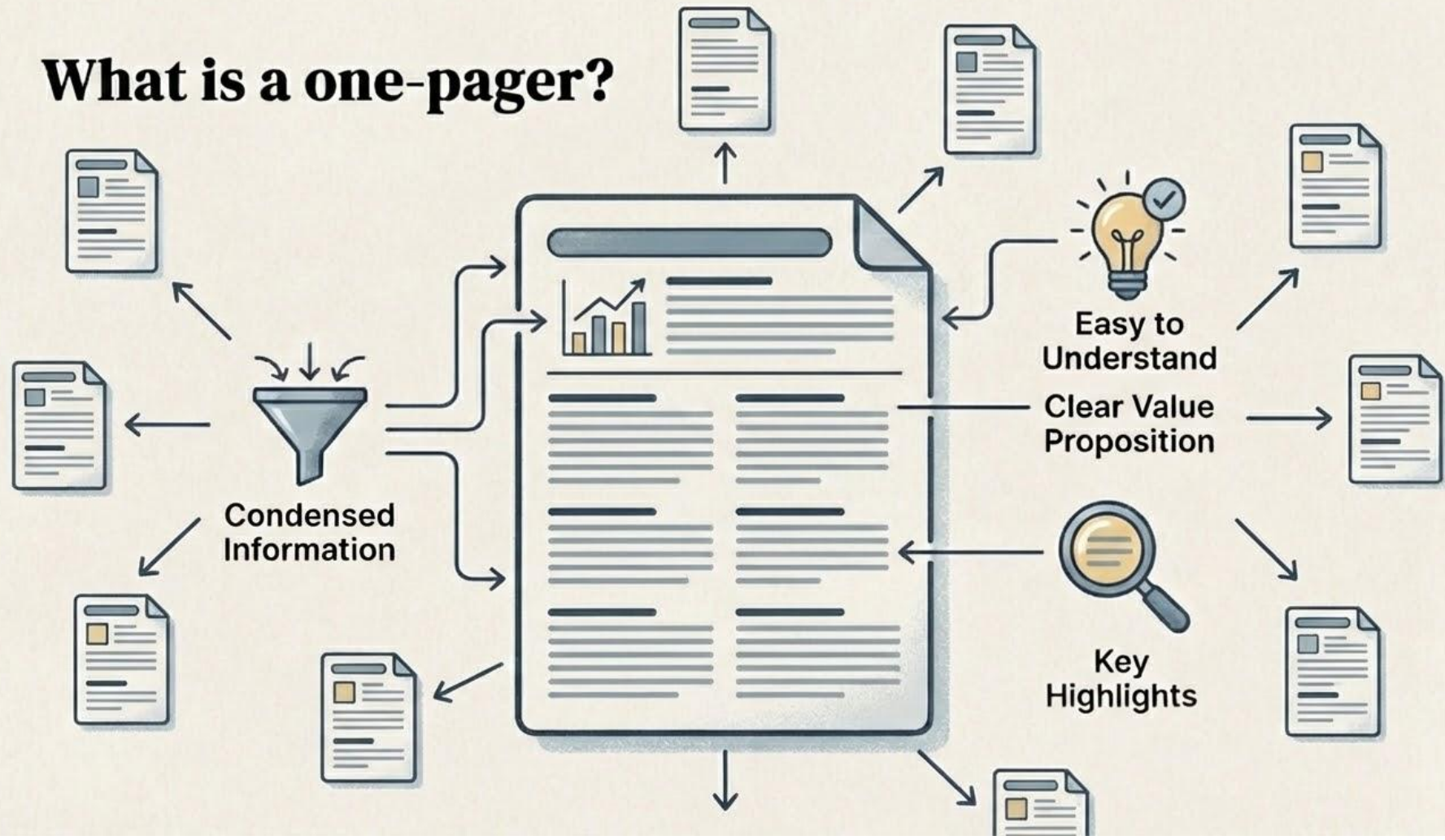
The Bridge
(Your Solution)

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The Proposition
(Public Good)

What is a one-pager?



The “Heart” of the Proposal: Purpose & Opportunity

1. **Purpose:** One sentence describing the project and the community benefit:
 - a. **For example:** “To advance public understanding of the threat of nuclear weapons by supporting a reporting fellow in Times Opinion to produce a series about those threats in an unstable world.”
2. **Opportunity Statement (The 3-Paragraph Logic):**
 - a. **The Challenge/Opportunity:** What is happening in the world that deserves attention?
 - b. **The Intervention:** What will you do with the funding to address it?
 - c. **The Why Us:** Why is your channel/project uniquely suited for this?

Success: Deliverables vs. Indicators

1. Deliverables (The “What”):

- a. Tangible items produced (e.g., 3 investigative videos).
- b. Events hosted (e.g., 1 monthly town hall).

2. Indicators (The "How it's working"):

- a. Tracking performance/reach.
- b. Examples: Follower growth, community comments, attendance numbers.

The "So What?": Expected Outcomes

- How do you hope the community will change because of this work?
 - Example #1: Specific societal impact
 - Example #2: Shift in policy or awareness
 - Example #3: Long-term improvement in civic health.
- This section should answer the question: How will the affected community be impacted if this grant is successful.

Preparing a Budget

Approach 1: Bottom-Up



- Comprehensive list of all costs required to complete activities.
- *Focus:* Operational reality.

Approach 2: Top-Down

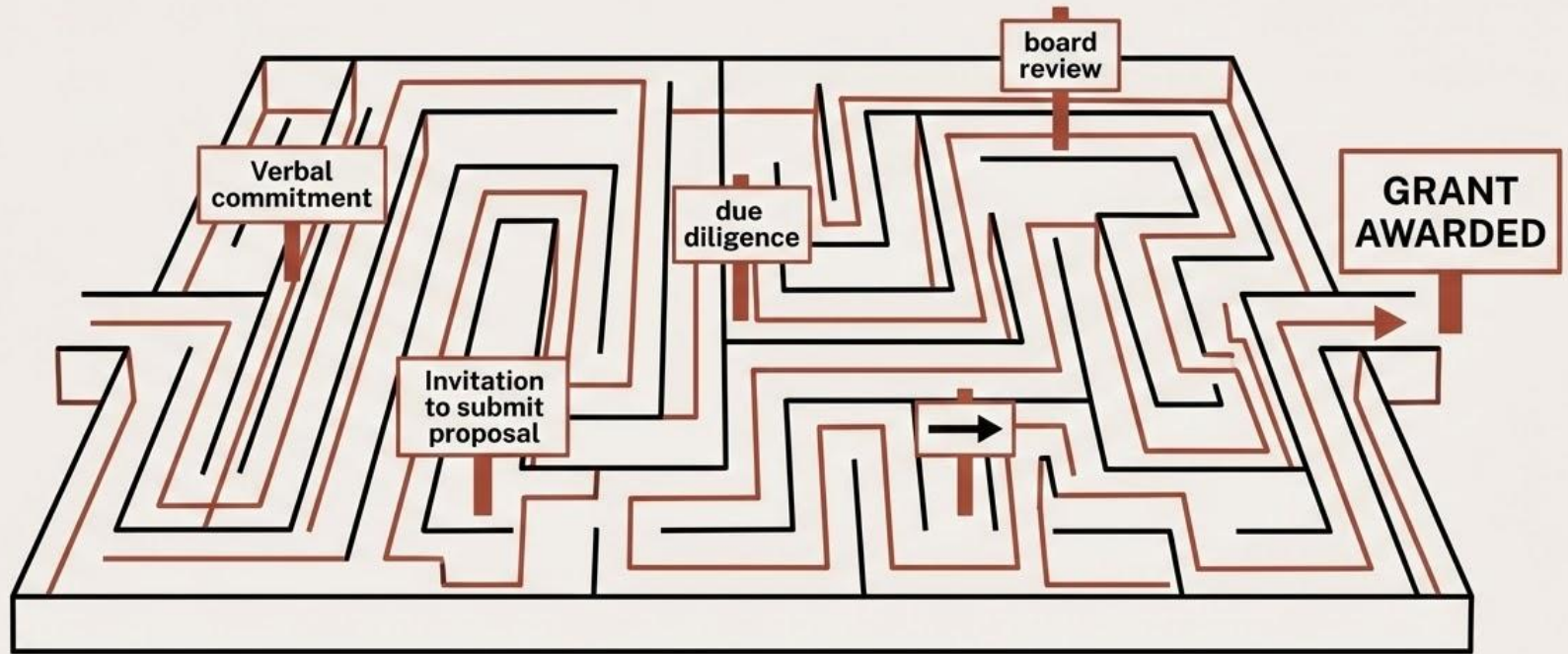


- Building a plan around a fixed award amount from a funder.
- *Focus:* Strategic prioritization.

Advice for creating budgets

- 1. Your time = Salary/Benefits.**
- 2. Your expertise = Salary/Benefits.**
- 3. Try to categorize all your contractors, freelancers or paid contributors as consultants (this language will look different depending on budget templates).**
- 4. If possible, include some funding for travel/entertainment.**
- 5. Assess your equipment and software needs ahead of building a budget.**
- 6. As creators, you likely won't do much re-granting.**
- 7. If you are using a fiscal sponsor, factor in a loss of 5-10% of your total grant to cover those costs.**

The Grantmaking Machinery



What we'll discuss in our next session

- 1. How to manage a grant-funded project**
 - a. Evaluating the strengths and weaknesses of accepting a grant**
 - b. Grant reporting and metrics**
 - c. Funder relations**

Questions?

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